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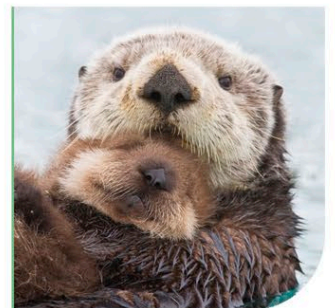
Animals make up the largest kingdom of living things. Driven by the need to eat food, and to escape being eaten, they are uniquely responsive to the world around them. The vast majority are invertebrates, but mammals and other chordates often outclass them in size, strength, and speed.



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INVERTEBRATES

Hugely varied in shape, invertebrates also have a wide range of lifestyles. Insects make up the largest group, but others include jellyfish, worms, and animals protected by a hard shell.



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CHORDATES

Most of the world's large animals are chordates. Externally, they can be covered in fur, feathers, or overlapping scales, but internally nearly all have a backbone, which makes up part of a bony skeleton.